



Post-26/11, is **INDIA**

The BEST assessment is that the Government's strategy has broadly worked but there's Home Minister Chidambaram gets a pat, but the threat remains and major systemic cha

Aroon Purie, Editor-in-Chief, INDIA TODAY: Our first meeting was in March 2009 when the Board of Experts on Security Terror (BEST) was set up as a part of the INDIA TODAY Group's campaign on the "War on Terror" which was launched in the aftermath of 26/11. The idea was to keep our audience briefed with expert viewpoints on security and terror and what can be done. Our focus continues to be on the threat of cross-border terrorism and in the last 11 months, nothing major has happened as far as a terrorist attack is concerned. Is this our good fortune or has the government done something?

Meanwhile, other security and terror-related issues have come up. Naxal terror is now on top of the national agenda and we want to hear from you on how the Government should tackle it. We can't, of course, stop looking at Pakistan which seems to have its own internal problems but doesn't appear to be repentant for what it does to India and continues on its stubborn path. How we should tackle Pakistan remains an issue. Add to all this, of course, is tensions with China. We are keen to hear from you how India is dealing with China and what it really needs to do.

Raj Chengappa, Managing Editor, INDIA TODAY: In March, the BEST assessment was that the Government had totally failed to tackle the terror threat post-26/11. We are just a month away from the first anniversary of 26/11 and we need an assessment as to whether we have progressed, have there been any big shifts or as Aroon mentioned, are we just lucky that we haven't had a major cross-border terrorist attack?



Ved Marwah, Former Governor, Jharkhand: A number of factors have helped in ensuring that we haven't had any major incidents since 26/11. Some credit for it goes to the Government and some to developments in Pakistan where the jihadis are busy fighting a battle for survival; India and Jammu and Kashmir (J&K) is no longer on top of their agenda. If the Pakistan Army wins, we will have trouble and if the ji-

hadis win, of course, we will have more trouble. P. Chidambaram taking over as the Union home minister has helped in creating a feeling of urgency in the security agencies—intelligence agencies, state police and paramilitary forces. Certain legislative actions have been taken, the law has been tightened with the Prevention of Unlawful Activities Act and an investigative agency has been set up. But